

ALBLD.PA pitch deck

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PITCH — ALBLD.PA — VERDICT

ADJUDICATED 2026-08-17 — KILL

Bilendi SA (Euronext Growth Paris, ALBLD). Last €12.76 (pack tape 2026-08-18; both benches worked off €12.80). 52-week range €12.62–€22.80 — the stock is roughly 1% above its 52-week low and 44% below its high. **We do not own it, we are not buying it, and no order or price alert is being armed.**

What we believe

Bilendi is a real business — one of four sizeable owners of online survey panels in Europe — but the shares are the leftover slice of a company that borrowed heavily to buy a competitor (Netquest) at the top of its own cycle, and there is no price at which the current cash generation pays us to own that slice.

The arithmetic, checked against the audited accounts rather than the screen:

Item	Figure	Source
Shares outstanding, 31/07/2026	4,654,779	AMF voting-rights notice
Market value @ €12.80	€59.6M	arithmetic
Borrowings less cash	€58.09M – €10.46M = €47.64M net debt	FY25 accounts, notes 5 & 8
Enterprise value (equity + net debt)	~€107M	arithmetic
FY25 free cash flow (operating cash €15.0M – capex €10.0M)	€4.98M	FY25 cash flow statement
Price of the whole business per euro of cash it makes	21.5x	arithmetic
Debt that must be repaid in the next 12 months	€7.25M	note 8 maturity table

So the business generates €4.98M of cash and owes €7.25M of principal within a year. The gap is filled by running down the €10.46M cash pile — while revenue is *shrinking* 5.3% on a like-for-like basis, with France down 10.5%.

Two things make the reported numbers look better than the cash does:

1. **Reported profit is a tax artifact.** FY25 net income of €2.99M sits on pre-tax profit of only €2.16M. The difference is a €0.78M tax *credit* from recognising Netquest's accumulated losses —

paper, not cash. Cash tax actually paid was €2.14M, essentially the entire pre-tax profit. Normalised, net income is about €1.6M.

2. The headline margin routes recurring costs off the income statement. The cost of recruiting panel members — people who answer the surveys, the raw input of the business — is capitalised as an intangible asset and written off over twelve months. €5.6M of the €9.6M of FY25 intangible additions is panel recruitment. A cost with a one-year life is not an investment; it is payroll for the panel. Adjust for it and the “21.9% EBITDA margin” is roughly **11% on a cash basis**.

That is why a company that grew revenue 42% (via acquisition) produced *less* cash than it did debt-free the year before: free cash flow fell from €8.2M in 2024 to €5.0M in 2025.

Lender protections point the same way. The €44M six-year pool loan (€39.2M outstanding) is secured by pledges over the shares of both operating subsidiaries — Netquest (€44M) and Bilendi GmbH (€6M) — plus a €4M key-man insurance assignment on the 15.1% founder-CEO. No covenant ratios are disclosed anywhere in the published accounts, though the auditor bills for covenant certifications, so covenants exist and we cannot see them.

Conclusion: this is not a cheap stock that fell too far. It is a leveraged equity stub whose cash generation does not cover its own debt schedule.

What the market believes

The market is not confused about this name, and that matters.

- Three analysts cover it. EuroLand Corporate initiated with a €26.40 target when the stock was €16.50; it has fallen ~22% *since* that initiation. The market has read the bull case and declined it.
- But EuroLand is **sponsored research announced by the company’s own press release** — the issuer pays for the coverage. That target is not an independent opinion about value; it is marketing. So “the analysts say €26.40” is not evidence that we are buying something others have mispriced.
- Management reaffirmed a target of €175–200M of revenue by 2030 — roughly double today’s revenue, from a base that is currently shrinking. Reaching it means more acquisitions, and the collateral that would fund them is already pledged. The market appears to be pricing dilution or more debt rather than the target.
- Sellers are getting done at the low on €75–80k of daily volume. There is no visible forced seller, no index deletion, no lock-up expiry. This looks like ordinary de-rating, not a mechanical dislocation.

The honest summary of the other side: the market believes leverage plus shrinking revenue plus opaque covenants deserves a low multiple. We agree with the market.

Why we might have edge

Three real informational advantages existed here, and we did capture them:

1. **The screen was wrong about the size of the company.** Our own screen carried 5.049M shares; the AMF notice says 4,654,779 — an 8.5% overstatement of market value. Anyone screening on the wrong share count is valuing a different company.
2. **The screen ignored the debt entirely.** Net debt is 80% of market value. A market-cap-only screen sees a €60M company at 1.17x sales; the actual business costs €107M. Any comparison built on market cap alone is meaningless here.
3. **The panel-recruitment capitalisation is not in any summary, database, or press release.** It is one sentence on page 20 of the French-language consolidated accounts. It halves the true margin. Anyone reading the EBITDA line from a data vendor is reading a number that has been legitimately but materially reshaped by an accounting policy.

That is genuine work. **But note honestly what it produced: a reason not to own it, not a tradeable edge.** We never obtained an independent forecast of 2026 free cash flow to compare with our €5M estimate, so we cannot say “the market expects X and we expect Y.” We are rejecting on absolute economics, which is defensible but produces nothing we can be scored on later.

Why it might be priced in

Symmetrically, here is the case that we are late and adding nothing:

- The stock is at its 52-week low, down 44% from the high. Whatever we discovered, the price has already moved a long way in the direction our findings imply.
- The FY25 accounts have been public for months. The pledges, the maturity ladder, the capitalisation policy and the tax credit are all disclosed — clearly, in a well-drafted French GAAP filing that ties to the cent. We found things a data vendor missed; we did not find anything the company hid.
- The genuine bull point survives our attack: Bilendi trades at 1.17x sales, versus the 1.99x it paid for Netquest. An industry buyer might well pay more than the market does. If someone acquires this company, our carry arithmetic will have been the wrong question. We accept that risk knowingly — a takeout is a possible outcome we are declining to underwrite, because the pledged collateral and undisclosed covenants mean a buyer negotiates with the lenders first and the minority shareholders second.
- Cash of €10.46M covers roughly two years of the amortisation shortfall, and part of capex is discretionary. The company is not about to fail. It just does not pay us enough to own it.

What we checked ourselves

Every line below was checked at a primary source this session. The rows marked **BENCH ERROR** are places our own analysts got it wrong and were corrected.

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Share count 4,654,779 / market cap €59.6M	Read the AMF L.233-8 voting-rights notice of 31/07/2026 directly	4,654,779 shares, capital €372,382.32; year-end 4,640,279 plus option exercises	YES — and it exposes an 8.5% error in our own screen
Net debt €47.64M	FY25 consolidated accounts, notes 5 and 8	€58,091,699 borrowings – €10,456,144 cash = €47,635,555	YES, to the euro
Enterprise value / free cash flow	Arithmetic on the above	€107M ÷ €4.98M = 21.5x	YES
BENCH ERROR — first analyst said EV was €121M (24x)	Second bench re-read note 7	The €13.83M “provisions” are unredeemed panelist reward points, not debt. Charges of €6,202,727 vs releases of €6,555,930 — the liability actually <i>shrank</i> excluding the acquisition, and its annual cost already sits inside the cash flow. Counting it as debt double-counted it	REFUTED — our own error. Corrected to €107M / 21.5x. Ironically the same type of overstatement the first bench was hunting for elsewhere
Debt repayment schedule	Note 8 maturity table	€7,248,948 due within 1 year, €28,546,924 in 1–5 years, €22,295,827 beyond; cash fell €5,428,187 during FY25	YES
Reported profit flattered by tax	Note 19	Pre-tax €2,156,224; tax was a €780,648 <i>credit</i> , from recognising €1,647,245 of losses (Netquest €1,606K). Cash tax paid €2,137,539 — 99% of pre-tax profit	YES, and worse than first stated
Panel recruitment capitalised	FY25 accounts, page 20	“Other intangible assets correspond to the costs of acquiring panel members, amortised over 12 months” — €5.6M of €9.6M of additions. Cash margin ~11% vs 21.9% headline	YES — new finding, missed by the first bench
Suspected hidden earn-out on Netquest	Notes 7, 10, 23	No contingent consideration. Respondi’s €600K guarantee paid Dec-2025, Tandemz tranches paid H1-2025, subsequent events “none”	REFUTED — our suspicion was wrong. Stated for balance
Covenants exist but are undisclosed	Notes 21, 25	Auditor bills for “certifications relating to bank covenants”; no ratio disclosed anywhere. Pledges: Netquest shares €44M, Bilendi GmbH €6M; €4M key-man assignment on M. Bidou, consented Dec-2025	CONFIRMED ABSENT — the accounts contain a drafting slip (a footnote says GmbH where the table says Netquest); the security package is confirmed either way
Interest rate hedge	Note 21	Collar: cap 3.00% / floor 1.38%, notional €39,233,332, expires 29/03/2029. The floor means rate cuts do not help either	YES
Organic revenue –5.3%, France –10.5%	H1-2026 revenue press release	Confirmed	YES
BENCH ERROR — first analyst said	Second bench recomputed with the corrected EV	At €9 the business costs €89.5M — 17.9x cash flow. To reach a 10x price the whole business must be worth €50M, which is	REFUTED — our own error. The conclusion (no price

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
equity value is negative at €9		roughly just the debt, leaving about + €0.51/share — thin, but positive, not negative	works) is unchanged, but the file must carry the right number
€26.40 analyst target is an independent second opinion	Traced the initiation to the issuer's own announcement	It is sponsored research paid for by the company. It is not an independent mark on value	REFUTED as an anchor — we did not kill the name for having few analysts; we killed the <i>independence</i> of the one target we could see
BENCH ERROR — “un-ownable because too illiquid”	Recomputed against our own position-size rules	Daily volume ~5,489 shares (€75–80k). At a 1%-of-volume participation cap, a 1% position in a ~\$1.03M book (~\$10.3k) takes about 12 trading days to build and as long to exit. Slow and one-way — a constraint on sizing, not a reason to reject	STRUCK FROM THE RECORD. The kill rests entirely on the cash arithmetic. If the economics were good we would buy it slowly
PROCESS DEFECT — the competitor comparison	Audit of our own case files	Two opposing-case documents were filed for this name (2026-08-17, 01:06 and 01:08) and the reviewing bench only ever read the first. The second one's decisive claim — that the “our decline is milder than Cint's –20.5%” comfort was based on a <i>Q3-2025</i> datum, while Cint's Q1-2026 printed +2.6% growth — was therefore never tested by anyone	UNTESTED. It is a web-sourced claim about a third party's results and enters this file as plausible but unaudited. If true, Bilendi is losing share to a recovering competitor rather than riding out an industry downturn — a materially worse story than the one we killed it on
Filing quality	Read 35/35 pages of the consolidated accounts	French GAAP (ANC 2024-05), no lease-accounting inflation of EBITDA, every figure ties	YES — this is a well-disclosed company with a bad balance sheet. We are not accusing anyone of anything

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

There is no entry. No price level is being armed, on purpose. Arming a buy price would tie a purchase to a cash-flow number this review has ruled disputed. What follows are the conditions under which the name may be looked at again, reproduced exactly as adjudicated:

- **DATE-CERTAIN, ISSUER-PRIMARY: 2026-10-07, H1-2026 detailed results** (company financial calendar — this is an issuer calendar date, not a yfinance guess). Reopen ONLY on the conjunction: 30/06/2026 net debt ≤ EUR45M AND H1 EBITDA margin ≥ 21% AND covenant terms actually disclosed with ≥ 30% headroom AND organic revenue ≥ 0%. Any single leg failing

keeps the name dead. Abort-side: net debt > EUR50M or H1 EBITDA margin < 19% confirms the LBO-stub read and the name is closed for the cycle.

- **DATA (the real reopen, undated): FCF rebased to $\geq$ EUR8M on a full year with intangible capex below 9% of sales** — i.e. the 2024 cash-generation level restored after the Netquest integration. Nothing else changes the carry bar; a revenue recovery that runs through capitalised panelist acquisition does not count.
- **NO PRICE GATE IS ARMED, DELIBERATELY.** The brief's EUR9.0 tripwire is VOID (17.9x EV/FCF on the corrected EV) and arming any level would anchor a purchase to an FCF number this court has ruled disputed. If a level is wanted for monitoring only, it is ~EUR6 — and even there it works only if FCF is already demonstrably $\geq$ EUR8M, which makes the FCF gate the binding one and the price incidental.
- **AUDIT (owed, cheap): verify the second red bench's Cint claim at the primary** — Cint Group Q1-2026 report, constant-currency revenue growth and vintage. If Cint really has returned to growth while Bilendi runs -5% cc, the class flips from sector cycle to company-specific share loss and even the 2026-10-07 conjunction should be tightened. This is currently the only untested decisive claim in the file.
- **EVENT: any refinancing, covenant waiver, equity raise or acquisition announcement.** With Netquest and Bilendi GmbH shares both pledged and a EUR4M key-man delegation on the 15.1% founder, a financing event is the moment the undisclosed covenant package becomes visible — and it is also the moment the reaffirmed EUR175-200M-by-2030 target (roughly 2x revenue from a shrinking base) has to be paid for.

Sizing, if it ever reopens: maximum 1% of the book (~\$10.3k on a ~\$1.03M book), built over roughly 12 trading days at no more than 1% of daily volume, with the same exit horizon assumed before entry. Any gain would be a capital gain taxed at short-term rates for a long stretch given the build time; there is no dividend, so no distribution to tax-adjust and French withholding is moot. There are **no adds and no trims** to define, because there is no position.

Catalyst date: 2026-10-07 (H1-2026 detailed results, issuer financial calendar) — approximately 36 trading days out, far outside any pre-results window, so nothing was owed before it and nothing was skipped.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- dated pack ALBLD.PA|2026-10-07: ALBLD.PA: H1-2026 detailed results — reopen only on the conjunction: 30/06/2026 net debt $\leq$ EUR45M AND H1 EBITDA margin $\geq$ 21% AND covenants

What remains unverified

Stated plainly, because the kill would be weaker or stronger depending on these:

1. **The competitor's current trajectory.** Whether Cint has genuinely returned to growth (+2.6% constant currency in Q1-2026) while Bilendi runs -5% is unconfirmed at the primary source. It is the single most consequential open item: it decides whether this is an industry downturn or Bilendi losing customers.
2. **Covenant terms and headroom.** Confirmed absent from every published document. We are underwriting an unknowable tail on a company carrying 2.4x leverage, and we will not know until the company chooses to disclose — possibly not even on 2026-10-07.
3. **What anyone independent forecasts for 2026 free cash flow.** We never obtained one. So we cannot state a difference between our view and the consensus view; we are rejecting on the absolute numbers. Honest, but it means this file contains no prediction that can later be graded.
4. **Two of the three analysts.** Only EuroLand's relationship with the company was audited. The other two were not.
5. **Live price.** The broker quote was permission-denied this session; both benches worked from the 2026-08-17/18 data-vendor tape (€12.76–€12.80). The next print date in the data pack was blank — 2026-10-07 comes from the company's own financial calendar, not from a data vendor's guess.
6. **The 2030 revenue target's funding.** Management reaffirmed €175–200M by 2030. How it gets paid for — when the collateral is pledged and free cash flow is €5M — is not disclosed and is a live dilution risk.

Primary sources: [Bilendi SA FY25 consolidated accounts \(notes 5–8, 10, 16, 19–21, 23, 25 read in full\)](#) · [AMF voting-rights notice, 31/07/2026](#) · [Cint Group Q1-2026 report \(claim pending audit\)](#)

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Note on the fence: price_gates is deliberately empty. The €9 tripwire in the original brief is void (17.9x on the corrected enterprise value) and the ~€6 level is monitoring-only — it works solely if free cash flow is already ≥ €8M, which makes the cash-flow test the binding one. Arming any price here would auto-arm a buy against a number this review ruled disputed. The reopen is a data test with a date attached, not a level.